

Asian steppe

A steppe is a high, grassy, mostly treeless plain. Animals here live on grass and other plants—or on the animals that do! They must be able to survive freezing winters, hot summers, and harsh wind, and to go long periods without water. On the steppe, watering holes are in short supply.

Central Asian tortoise

Also called the steppe tortoise, this animal's shell is almost as wide as it is long. It has claws on each foot—and one on its tail, too!



This nocturnal animal can cover 11 miles (18 km) a night in its search for food.

Steppe polecat

This wild cat's coat turns from frosty gray in winter to reddish gray in spring.

Pallas's cat

Wild horses live in herds of females and foals led by a male, called a stallion. Stallions fight over who gets to lead.

Przewalski's wild horse

The onager looks like a horse, but is smaller and brays like a donkey.

Steppe eagle

This bird hovers above its prey before swooping down and grabbing it with its powerful talons.

This squirrel digs two types of burrows: one for hibernation, and one to hide in from predators like eagles.

Little ground squirrel

Tashkent

Dushanbe

Bishkek

Onager

Bobak marmot

The bobak digs burrows up to 13–16 ft (4–5 m) deep, where it hibernates up to six months each year.

HABITAT KEY

- Wetlands
- Temperate grasslands
- Mountains
- Coniferous forests
- Deciduous forests
- Cold desert

SCALE

0 200 miles
0 200 kilometers



Peregrine falcon

These falcons normally hunt other birds. When hunting, peregrines make a steep dive called a "stoop." During a stoop, they can reach speeds of up to 150 mph (240 kph)!

Location

The Asian steppe stretches from west of the Caspian Sea, through central Asian Russia, and as far east as the Altai Mountains.

